NOVA SCHOOL OF SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

Interação Pessoa-Máquina

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Individual Assignment

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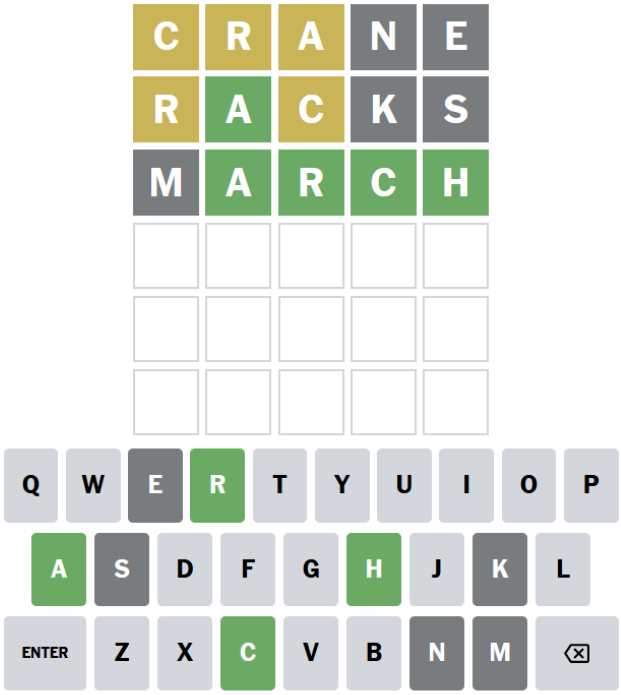
Good Interface Design: Wordle feedback system

Objective

Wordle is a daily word puzzle. The player has six attempts to guess a five-letter word. The interface must let anyone start playing in seconds, understand the rules without instructions, and finish in a few minutes.

Aspect analyzed

The color-coded feedback on the grid and the on-screen keyboard.



Good aspects

- After every guess, each letter turns green (right letter, right place), yellow (right letter, wrong place), or gray (wrong letter).
- The on-screen keyboard repeats the same color scheme, so the player doesn't need to remember which letters were already tried.
- Invalid words are rejected immediately with a small shake animation and short message.
- When the game ends, the result can be copied as a grid of colored squares that doesn't reveal the answer.

Why it is good

- **Immediate feedback**: The player always knows the result of an action right after doing it.
- **Recognition over recall**: The keyboard acts as external memory, which reduces the mental effort of tracking letters.
- **Learnability**: The rules are learned by playing, because the feedback itself explains them. No tutorial is needed.
- **Consistency**: The same three colors mean the same thing in the grid and on the keyboard.
- **Error prevention**: Invalid words are blocked before costing an attempt.

Limitations

Colors can become an issue for color-blind people. The game addresses this with a high-contrast mode.

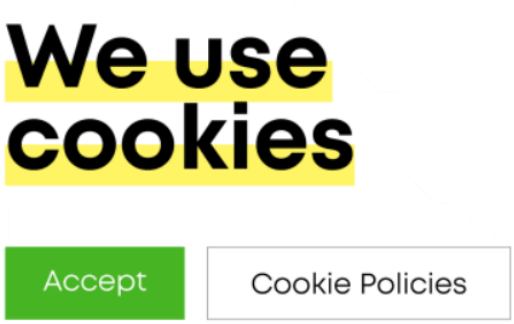
Bad Interface Design: Cookie consent banner

Objective

A cookie banner asks visitors whether they accept tracking cookies, as required by European data protection law (GDPR). It should let the user make a free, informed choice quickly and then continue to the consent.

Aspect analyzed

The choice between accepting and refusing cookies



Bad aspects

- “Accept” button is often a large, bright button. Refusing is often a small text link, or hidden behind a button labeled “setting”, “manage” or “policies”
- Refusing can take several screens or dozens of individual toggles, sometimes already switched on, while accepting takes one click
- The banner often covers the content, so you can’t read the page until you answer.
- Wording like “We value your privacy” doesn’t say what is actually being collected

Why it is bad

- Unequal effort: One option takes one click and the other takes many, so the website influences users toward the choice the website prefers.
- Visual hierarchy used against the user: Color, size and position make one option look like the “correct” one.
- User control and freedom: The user can’t easily say no, so the choice isn’t really free.
- Clarity: Technical or vague language prevents an informed decision.

Why I think it was designed this way

- Business model: Tracking data feeds advertising revenue, so websites want as many “accept clicks as possible.
- Minimal legal compliance: Companies often do the least needed to show a banner exists, rather than making the choice easy.
- A/B testing: Designs are optimized for acceptance rate, so the version that tires users into accepting wins.

Suggested improvements

1. Show “Accept all” and “Reject all” side by side with the same size and color.
2. Make refusing one click, so it becomes as easy as accepting (currently the norm in Europe).
3. Never pre-tick optional categories.
4. Use plain language, such as “Show me personalized ads: Yes / No”, instead of technical terms
5. Don’t block the page’s content, or at least, keep the banner small